

“Data integrity and availability is critical in today’s business environment. The needs of today’s business environment are addressed by providing a family of smart array controllers and smart storage batteries that allow data migration and provide exceptional data protection, while minimising the long-term costs of that protection.”

Q Blade, tower or rack—which is the best choice for an IT manager?

For businesses that are new to servers, we recommend entry level rack and tower servers that are simple, easy to deploy and affordable, having been designed for SMB businesses that need the right size for first time workload deployment.

For growing businesses or new growth customers, we recommend the mid-range rack and tower servers, which are optimised with the right balance of storage, performance, efficiency and manageability to address multiple workloads for growing SMB and enterprise businesses.

To customers that have traditionally used IT and are seeking the industry servers of choice, we recommend the enterprise class rack and tower servers, as well as the blade servers, which are designed with flexible choices for compute intensive workloads requiring high system performance, manageability, expansion and security for SMB, enterprise and HPC businesses.

The Compute Strategy that HP has adopted is to focus on providing the right compute for the right workload at the right economics, every time. Different server form factors are positioned as per this strategy. HP’s server portfolio addresses the essential needs of customers who are either new to servers or who are positioned to grow and expand their business.

For organisations requiring the most demanding scale-up workloads, the mission critical rack servers are the best, as they deliver unparalleled scalability, reliability and availability to unleash the power of business data.

Q What is the right mix of processor and memory that one needs to look at while choosing the server? How important is the right mix?

The cloud, mobility, Big Data and security are some of the key mega trends that are generating new business opportunities. This is driving line of business (LOB) executives to deliver new products and services faster, increase operational efficiencies and grow revenue, margins and market share. In order to offer a compute platform to address the different application needs, a right mix of compute capacity and memory is mandatory. The number of CPU cores are growing to offer more compute power, and the memory is becoming bigger and faster to feed those CPU cores so that data seek time and latency can be reduced.

Q What kind of server support drives should one look for to achieve the ultimate hard disk performance?

As data, storage and accessibility requirements grow exponentially, storage solutions need to meet a variety of needs. Data integrity and availability is critical in today’s business environment. The needs of today’s business environment are addressed by providing a family of smart array controllers and smart storage batteries that allow data migration and provide exceptional data protection, while minimising the long-term costs of that protection.

Q It is said that network attached storage can provide an alternative to servers in some ways. Do you agree?

A network attached storage (NAS) appliance offers file-based access using the NFS (Network File System) or CIFS (Common Internet File System) protocols. A server connects to a NFS server system to access a file-based storage for the application that runs on it. Such files can also be accessed by another server connected in the network at a different time. NFS/CIFS systems allow a user on a server to access files over a network much like local storage is accessed.

On the other hand, a server is used to deploy applications like Microsoft Office after installing an operating system, like Microsoft Windows 2008. In NAS, customers can’t deploy any applications. Such servers may have local storage or storage over a network.

Q How does one choose the right ports for a server?

The application’s footprint determines the kind and number of ports required for any server. With the increasing proliferation of virtualisation and the cloud, a lot of compute capacity is needed to process large amounts of data. The tech industry is engaged in extracting contextual information out of Big Data for pragmatic decision making. This calls for consolidating a large number of virtual machines in a physical server and providing a 40 GB network bandwidth per server node to support the high-speed VMs’ east-west traffic, multiple low latency concurrent Vmotion sessions, to consolidate structured and unstructured data, and run the contextual computing applications. Apart from data traffic requirements, a separate dedicated management access is required for the servers to be managed individually or as a group.

Q What are the parameters to be kept in mind while choosing an operating system for a server?

OS selection depends on multiple factors, the most important criterion being the business need. Procurement, deployment, maintenance and upgrade cycles determine the selection of the OS, which impacts cost, employee productivity, ease of use and the learning curve. The business application platform dictates the selection of the operating system. 